

ENGINE · INLINE CODE

# Inline code that reads on every surface

One chip rule, every surface — fill and border now derive from the ink, so the chip adapts instead of breaking.

THE PROBLEM

# A single `section code` rule, blind to its surface

The same `--accent` ink on a fixed `--bg-alt` fill — fine on the canvas, wrong everywhere else.

# Where the old chip broke

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- Dark bookends and the split-panel rail
  - They paint a dark surface without flipping `color-scheme`, so a light `--bg-alt` chip lands on dark
- Card and panel fills
  - A chip filled with `--bg-alt` vanishes into a `--bg-alt` card
- Accent-soft callouts
  - The gray chip fill clashes with the tinted `--accent-soft` panel
- Contrast was audited for the wrong pair
  - Themes measure `--accent` on `--bg`, but the chip rides `--bg-alt` — mustard fell to 3.89:1, below AA

# The fix — a `currentColor` wash

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- The chip ink is `--code-inline-fg`
  - Defaults to `--accent`; one value re-tunes the whole chip
- Fill and border derive from the ink
  - `color-mix(in srgb, currentColor 10%, transparent)` — always a subtle delta from the surface
- Surfaces rebind only the ink
  - Dark islands set `--code-inline-fg` to the on-dark tier; the wash follows

## KEY INSIGHT

Rebind one token, not three. Because the fill tracks `currentColor`, setting the ink is enough — the chip stays legible whether it sits on a card, a callout, or a dark rail.

DARK RAIL

# The chip on `--` `bg-dark`

A reference to `var(--accent)` on the dark rail now inks on-dark instead of flashing a near-white box.

## Right zone keeps the canvas treatment

A `npm run build` reference reads as a soft accent chip on the light side

## Same token, two surfaces

The rail rebinds `--code-inline-fg`; the right zone inherits the default

# On tinted card fills

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## Canvas

A `var(--token)` chip is a faint accent wash

## Card

The same `var(--token)` chip stays a delta from the `--bg-alt` fill

## Callout

On `--accent-soft` the chip deepens instead of clashing

## Dark

On a dark rail the ink flips and the wash follows

AA THROUGHOUT

# Inline code, in order

*Surface-aware by construction — and ready  
for the interpreted-code proposal to build on.*